

Destiny calls

Elizabeth's uncle—not yet crowned King Edward VIII—seemed carefree at first. But he was about to make an important decision ...

In 1936, Edward told his family and friends that he wanted to marry his close companion, Wallis Simpson. Most people in Britain knew little about her, except that she was American—and a married woman.

Wallis set about getting a divorce. By May 1937, the date planned for the King's coronation, she would be free to marry him. This was a problem for the British Government and the Church of England. They had agreed that the King might marry, but had also said

What is a coronation?

A coronation is a religious ceremony to crown a new king or queen.